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PIETER ELBERS
CEO, INDIGO



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CAMPBELL WILSON
CEO, AIR INDIA



“EIL is playing a crucial role in providing tech solutions... We’re giving support and consultancy services for production of bio-ATF for MRPL”

VARTIKA SHUKLA
CMD, ENGINEERS INDIA LTD

Asia Pacific and Middle East region, while the Hyderabad airport has received level 3+ accreditation.

However, a collaborative approach is important. “As a leading stakeholder in this sector, we understand the significance of phasing out fossil fuel-dependent equipment in ground handling and embracing eco-friendly solutions such as electric vehicles (EVs), bridge-mounted equipment, taxibots, etc.,” says Murali Ramachandran, the India CEO of Çelebi Aviation Holding.

GLOBAL EXPERIENCE

Airlines the world over have become more conscious. For instance, on a recent United Airlines domestic flight in the US, an ad played on the in-flight entertainment screen. The airline has roped in the popular show *Sesame Street*’s Oscar the Grouch as its Chief Trash Officer!

Then there is Swiss Air, whose flight operations’ environmental performance is usually measured by fuel consumption. From this, key performance indicators (KPI) are derived, such as the fuel consumption to transport one passenger every 100 km or the CO₂ emission by tonne kilometre transported. Additionally, the airline uses a software developed by Google Cloud to further optimise its flight operations. “We conduct applied research within the framework of the Single European Sky that advocates for a less fragmented airspace structure, so that aircraft can fly to their destinations without unnecessary detours, at the optimal flight altitudes and with continuous descent flights,” says Mela-

nie Heiniger, Head of Sustainability at SWISS.

CONSCIOUS TRAVELLERS

Consumers, too, are becoming increasingly aware of the environmental impact of their choices. For instance, the vegan options on board Emirates feature a variety of greens, fruits, and vegetables sourced from several UAE-based suppliers, including fresh locally grown kale and lettuce from Bustanica, the world’s largest hydroponic vertical farm. “As a result, we have seen a 154 per cent increase in vegan meals served onboard between 2021 and 2022, with over 280,000 plant-based meals consumed in the past year,” says an Emirates spokesperson.

Some airlines are even offering customers the chance to pay for their carbon emissions through a green fare or donations to environment-friendly initiatives. “Like the rest of the industry, it’s going to be a series of incremental approaches building on each other to get to that 2050 timeline. Technology, SAFs, sustainable practices, all of those things layering on each other because there is no magic bullet to this problem,” says Air India’s Wilson.

“If we continue to work closely with manufacturers on engine efficiency, SAF and other such initiatives that’s really the way forward for us,” adds IndiGo’s Elbers. Therefore, like the line from the Pink Floyd song, the little or big steps required in this regard have to be acted upon determinedly. **BT**

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